

Some voters see red over districts

Republicans in rural Northern California balk at a plan to redraw voting maps.

By JESSICA GARRISON

COTTONWOOD — When the talk turned to politics at the OK Corral bar in this historic stagecoach town on Tuesday night, retired nurse Ovie Hays, 77, spoke for most of the room when she summed up her view of Gov. Gavin Newsom's redistricting plan.

"I don't want Democrats around," she said. "They have gone too far in controlling us. We won't have a say in anything."

Nearby, a man in hard-worn cowboy boots agreed with Hays — using much more colorful language. He works as a ranch hand and said he'd just come from fixing a goat pen.

"The morons in charge, and the morons that put [those] morons in charge need to understand where their food comes from," he said. He declined to see his name printed, like a lot of folks in this part of Shasta County and neighboring counties.

In its current form, California's 1st Congressional District, which sweeps south from the Oregon border almost to Sacramento, is larger than Massachusetts or Maryland or eight other states.

This is farm and forest country. From the glittering peaks and dense forests of Mt. Shasta and the Sierra Nevada, rivers course down to the valley floor, to vast fields of rice, endless orchards of peaches and golden, rolling grassland full of more cows than people. Voters here are concerned with policies that affect their water supply and forests, given

[See Redistricting, A7]

GOP lawmakers sharpen attack

California Republicans question transparency and cost of new voting maps. **CALIFORNIA, B1**



Minguela's family
ANGEL Rodrigo Minguela Palacios about six years ago.

DELIVERING FRUIT, THEN DETAINED

The driver was taking strawberries to a tearoom in Little Tokyo when Border Patrol agents happened to see him. Now his family has been broken apart.

By BRITTNY MEJIA

The strawberry delivery driver was making his last drop-off in Little Tokyo, unloading nearly a dozen boxes onto the sidewalk outside the Japanese American National Museum.

Inside the building, Gov. Gavin Newsom and his allies were holding a news conference about a Democratic Party plan to fight back against President Trump's efforts to maintain control of the U.S. House of Representatives through redistricting in Texas.

Angel Rodrigo Minguela Palacios knew nothing of the powerful men's clash as he stacked cardboard boxes filled with ripe, red fruit Thursday morning last week. He also didn't know that dozens of Border Patrol agents were amassing nearby.

Minguela was caught between the two spectacles. His life was about to be upended.

In the days that followed, Newsom accused the

Trump administration of trying to intimidate the president's political opponents by sending the immigration agents. Department of Homeland Security spokeswoman Tricia McLaughlin has said the agents were "focused on enforcing the law," not on Newsom.

Newsom has since submitted a Freedom of Information Act request seeking records from the administration about why agents arrived at the museum as he was announcing his latest skirmish with the president.

For Minguela, who has been in the country for close to a decade, that day felt a lot more personal. He was arrested by Border Patrol agents and now faces deportation back to Mexico. Speaking from behind a plexiglass window at the "B-18" federal detention center in downtown Los Angeles on Monday, Minguela stressed

[See Delivery, A14]



CARLIN STIEHL Los Angeles Times

SOURCES SAY Border Patrol agents targeted Little Tokyo because Gov. Newsom was there.

Ex-fire chief claims unjust removal

Kristin Crowley says in a legal filing that she was defamed by Mayor Karen Bass.

By RICHARD WINTON

The former Los Angeles fire chief filed a legal claim against the city Wednesday, alleging that Mayor Karen Bass "orchestrated a campaign of misinformation, defamation, and retaliation" to protect her political image after the most destructive wildfire in city history.

Kristin Crowley and her lawyers accuse Bass of ousting her, and repeatedly defaming Crowley as Bass sought to shift blame for the way the city handled the catastrophic Palisades fire "while concealing the extent to which she undermined public safety" with cuts to the fire department's budget.

The legal claim alleges that Bass scapegoated Crowley amid mounting criticism of the mayor's decision to attend a ceremony in Ghana on Jan. 7, when the fire erupted. Bass left Los Angeles despite knowing of the potential severe winds and deadly fire danger, the claim alleges.

"As the Fire Chief, for nearly three years, I advocated for the proper funding, staffing and infrastructure upgrades to better support and protect our Firefighters, and by extension, our communities," Crowley said in a statement to The Times. "The lies, deceit, exaggerations and misrepresentations need to be addressed with the only thing that can refute them — the true facts."

David Michaelson, counsel to the mayor, issued the following statement Wednesday: "We will not comment on an ongoing personnel claim, Mayor Bass is focused on the city's preparations for the hottest temperatures of the year and the potential for regional fire danger."

The claim is certain to revive concerns over whether city leaders were prepared to fight L.A.'s most destructive

[See Fire chief, A6]

Redistricting push advances in Texas

By JIM VERTUNO AND NICHOLAS RICCARDI

AUSTIN, Texas — Texas Republicans on Wednesday took the first step toward approving new congressional maps that would give their party as many as five new seats in the House of Representatives, sparking what's likely to be a national battle over redistricting.

The approval by Texas' GOP-controlled House of Representatives came at the urging of President Trump, who pushed for the extraordinary mid-decade revision of congressional maps to

give his party a better chance at holding on to the U.S. House in next year's election. The maps need to be approved by the state Senate and signed by Gov. Greg Abbott before they become official.

Texas state legislative Democrats delayed the vote by two weeks by fleeing the state this month in protest and were assigned round-the-clock police monitoring upon their return to ensure they attended Wednesday's session.

The approval of the Texas maps on an 88-52 party-line vote is likely to

[See Texas, A6]



MYUNG J. CHUN L.A. Times
KEVIN Lillenberg, 69, walks in Santa Clarita, which hit 102 degrees.

Heat is just one of three threats

Weather experts warn of heightened fire risk and thunderstorms. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Tick ailment in dogs is on rise

The increase in the lesser-known disease, anaplasmosis, could be a warning. **SCIENCE, A8**

Prep football storylines bloom

Mater Dei and St. John Bosco are on a collision course. Others face questions. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather
Hot.
L.A. Basin: 95/70. **B6**

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An alternative to police

Early results are promising for an effort to use unarmed crisis responders in L.A.

By LIBOR JANY

When Angelenos face a situation that requires calling 911 — such as encountering a person in the throes of a mental health crisis — the first responders are usually firefighters or armed police officers.

But a new report sug-

gests a third option holds promise for the future.

For the last year, Los Angeles has been testing a program that dispatches specially trained civilians who don't carry guns in response to certain calls for help. The report released this month by the city said the early results are encouraging.

"When deployed to non-violent, non-urgent calls for service, unarmed crisis responders have been shown to minimize the potential for escalation and address critical mental health emergencies in a manner that pri-

oritizes compassion and safety," the report said.

The use of so-called unarmed crisis responders, the report found, not only offers specialized care to people who need help, but it also allows "LAPD more time to focus on traditional law enforcement efforts."

The ongoing pilot program has teams of licensed clinicians, social workers, community workers and therapists who work in pairs, responding to calls around the clock, seven days a week. Over its first year,

[See Responders, A7]

SUVs take CHP undercover

Patrol's stealthy fleet looks just like civilian vehicles. Their target: reckless drivers.

By JAMES RAINEY

They're coming for you, California. And you aren't gonna see them coming.

They're the California Highway Patrol and they're riding in spiffy new SUVs that don't look like your dad-dy's cop car.

The CHP deployed 100 new Dodge Durangos a little more than three months ago. They're designed to escape easy detection. Gone is authoritarian black-and-white; replaced by a dreamy, civilian-style color palette. The SUVs also aren't outfitted like standard patrol cars. There's no push bumper, no giant antenna and no light bar mounted on the roof.

The Highway Patrol announced in early May that officers would begin cruising in the specially marked patrol vehicles "to crack down

on what can only be described as 'video game-style' driving on our highways." And for good reason: More than a third of all traffic fatalities in California are speed-related, according to a 2023 UC Berkeley study.

We all know what the CHP is talking about. These are the drivers who cut in and out of lanes like they're gunning for the pole position at Laguna Seca. They speed. They seem to delight in riding other people's bumpers. But the long arm of the law

[See CHP, A7]



ERIC GAY Associated Press

A PROTESTER at Texas' House chamber catches the attention of state Sen. Juan Hinojosa this week.